

Build Steps

Cowork is task-driven — give Copilot a job, optionally schedule it, let it use your M365.

1 Open Copilot Cowork

Open Microsoft 365 Copilot and switch to Cowork mode (left rail). Confirm the surfaces you have available — Cowork can act on your behalf across:

- Outlook (read, summarise, draft, send, schedule)
- Teams (chats, channels, post messages, read history)
- Calendar (find times, create meetings, prep briefs)
- SharePoint & OneDrive (read files, write Word/Excel/PowerPoint to your files)
- Power BI (semantic models, reports, DAX queries)

2 Paste the Headline Task

Open a new Cowork task and paste the prompt below. This is the worked example for Frontline — Shift Handover — adapt names, channels, and Power BI reports to your tenant before running.

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Every day at 6:00am, run the Shift Handover Digest:

1. Do NOT send/post automatically – leave the draft for me to review.
2. Open Frontline_Shifts_Data.xlsx from /Operations/Shifts/ in SharePoint. Read the rows for the last 24 hours across all sites (Early + Late + Night).
3. For each Site, summarise: ShiftType, LeadName, HeadCount vs plan, EquipmentCheckPassed, IncidentCount, NearMissCount, and the most recent HandoverNotes line.
4. Roll up Open Actions across all prior shifts – list anything not closed, oldest first. Tag each with the Site and the ShiftID where it was raised.
5. Detect repeat patterns: if the same incident category or equipment fault appears at the same Site twice in 7 days, flag it as a 'recurring near-miss'.
6. Check the 'Site Leads' Teams channel for the last 12 hours. Pull any message tagged @urgent or containing 'incident', 'injury', 'stop work'. Reconcile against the workbook – flag anything in chat but not yet logged.
7. Draft a single Teams message per Site to that Site's handover channel: top 3 carry-over actions, equipment status, any recurring near-miss flag, and a one-line 'safety focus' for the incoming shift. Keep it under 120 words, plain English.
8. Leave all drafts in the channel composer. Do NOT post.
9. If any High-severity incident is unlogged in the workbook, draft a direct Teams message to me with the ShiftID.
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3 Set the Schedule

In the task panel, choose Schedule and configure:

Frequency	Daily
Run Time	06:00 local (before Early shift starts)
Execution Mode	Inline (recommended) — task remembers context across runs

4 Verify the First Run

Run once now (Run now) before scheduling kicks in. Confirm:

- Every Site has its own Teams draft, not a combined one
- Open Actions list shows oldest items, not just yesterday's
- 'Recurring near-miss' fires only on a real repeat — try planting one
- Drafts are under 120 words and read like a shift lead wrote them

Try These Live

Copy any of these into a new Cowork task — one-shot or scheduled.

Pre-Shift Equipment Check

10 minutes before each shift start, read the most recent EquipmentCheckPassed value per Site. If N, draft a Teams DM to the incoming Lead with the failed item from the prior shift's HandoverNotes and a 'verify before start' checklist. Leave drafts.

Near-Miss Trend Pulse

Every Friday at 3pm: from the workbook, count NearMissCount by Site and ShiftType across the last 14 days. Identify the Site/Shift combo with the highest count and search the Site Leads channel for what people are saying. Build a one-page Word brief for the Ops Director with patterns and 2 suggested actions.

Incident Closure Sweep

Find Open Actions older than 7 days. Group by Owner (LeadName). Draft a short Teams message per Lead listing their open items with ShiftID and a 'please confirm closure or update' ask. Leave drafts.

Headcount Gap Read

From the workbook, list any shift in the last 7 days where HeadCount was below plan by 2+. Cross-reference with the Site Leads channel for context (sickness, cover, no-shows). Email the Workforce Planning DL a summary table and 2 questions for next planning cycle. Leave as draft.

How to Think About This Teammate

Cowork replaces:

- Verbal handovers that lose carry-over actions
- Near-misses logged in chat but never the workbook
- Equipment faults rediscovered at shift start

With:

- ✓ A 6am per-Site digest ready for the incoming Lead
- ✓ Recurring near-miss flags before they become incidents
- ✓ Drafts under 120 words, written for hand-held devices

Not a chatbot. A scheduled teammate with full access to your M365.

Tip for real-world use

Frontline reads on a phone, between tasks. Keep drafts under 120 words and lead with carry-over actions, not narrative. Add a final rule: 'If chat hints at an injury or stop-work event not in the workbook, DM me with the ShiftID.' Safety beats neatness.

You've built a Cowork teammate ✓

You now have a Copilot teammate that can:

- Land a handover digest before each shift
- Catch chat-only safety events
- Surface recurring near-misses early
- Close out carry-over actions consistently